



IntegraLayer

DPP Category Clarity · Perspective · Issue 01

Published 16 April 2026 | By Rachel Buchanan, Founder & CEO | Reading time ~4 min

DPP Category Clarity

Material identity and certificate verification are two distinct infrastructure layers. As the Digital Product Passport category takes commercial shape, treating them as one will hurt buyers, regulators, and the credibility of every claim in the stack.

On April 6, 2026, [SMX](#) launched its [Digital Material Passport Platform \(DMPP\)](#), a blockchain-backed system for material identity. The EU's central [ESPR](#) registry is expected mid-2026. As the first commercial DPP products ship, a category-level question gets urgent: *what exactly is being verified, and by whom?*

A Digital Product Passport carries claims. The claims come from different sources. Each source needs a different kind of verification.

MATERIAL LAYER

Establishes that a physical object is what it is claimed to be. That this batch of recycled polyethylene actually contains the percentage of post-consumer content on the label. That this gold ingot actually originated from the mine in the declaration. Verification ties a digital record to the physical good through markers (molecular, chemical, isotopic) that can be read back later. *SMX's DMPP is the keystone example.*

CERTIFICATE LAYER

Establishes that a claim about that material, typically issued by a third-party body, is real, current, and authentic. A [GRS](#) certificate. An [RJC Chain-of-Custody](#) certificate. A [ResponsibleSteel](#) site certification. Verification requires checking that the certificate record is authentic, unaltered, and still in effect at the moment of the check. *This is the layer IntegraLayer occupies.*

A system that verifies the material does not also verify the certificate, and vice versa.

Why the distinction matters now

The ESPR requires open, non-proprietary DPP infrastructure. This is law, not stylistic preference. It is written into [Article 9 of EU Regulation 2024/1781](#). A proprietary DPP platform can legitimately store material-identity data. The certifications used as inputs into those passports still need to be independently verifiable by any party, at any time, without relying on the platform operator that hosts them. That is a separate design requirement, and where certification bodies have the greatest exposure.

The risk of conflation

Buyers mistake material-marker systems for certificate verification and discover mid-audit that the certificate behind a claim was never the thing being checked. **Certification bodies** watch their certificates become inputs into platforms they do not control, with no independent way for downstream users to verify a certificate is authentic, current, and unchanged.

The category is a stack

The DPP category is a stack with four functions: material identity, certificate verification, passport registry, and product-level assembly. Each has its own infrastructure and accountable parties. As [ESPR](#), [CSRD](#), the [EU Deforestation Regulation](#), and the [FTC Green Guides](#) take force over the next three years, regulators will demand that each function be verifiable on its own terms.

SMX's DMPP and IntegraLayer's certificate-level verification are complementary infrastructure layers. The market will benefit from precision about which layer does which work.

For certification bodies navigating the DPP category

IntegraLayer provides neutral verification infrastructure that sits above existing certification platforms. Independently verifiable in real time via QR code and blockchain timestamping. Patent pending.

[Click here to get in touch →](#)

Trust isn't claimed. It's proven. The truth is verifiable.

IntegraLayer LLC | Patent Pending

Rachel Buchanan, Founder & CEO

[LinkedIn](#) | [integralayer.io](#)